
BOOKNEST

Library Information Management System

User Manual

Simple • Efficient • Comprehensive

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Version 1.0 | June 2026

For Library Staff & Members

Introduction

Welcome to BookNest, a modern and intuitive library management system designed to simplify your library experience. Whether you are a student, faculty member, or library staff, BookNest provides easy access to books, journals, and library services through a user-friendly interface.

This comprehensive user manual will guide you through all features and functions of BookNest, from logging in to managing your borrowing history. Each section includes step-by-step instructions, helpful tips, and answers to common questions.

What You'll Learn:

- How to access and navigate the BookNest system
- How to search for and borrow books
- How to manage your account and borrowing history
- How to renew books and avoid penalties
- How to access journals and additional resources

If you have any questions while using BookNest, refer to the Frequently Asked Questions section or contact the library help desk during office hours.

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1. Getting Started

1.1 What is BookNest?

BookNest is a modern library management system designed to make managing your library simple and efficient. Whether you are a librarian, student, or staff member, BookNest helps you:

- Search for books quickly and easily
- Borrow and return books without hassle
- Track your borrowing history
- Know your due dates and penalties
- Renew books when needed

1.2 System Requirements

To use BookNest, you need:

- A web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
- Internet connection
- Your library membership number
- Your password

1.3 How to Access BookNest

Follow these simple steps:

- Open Your Browser - Launch any web browser on your computer or mobile device
- Enter the URL - Type the library website address in the address bar
- Click Login - Look for the Login button on the homepage
- Enter Your Credentials - Type your username/membership ID and password

2. Logging In

2.1 Accessing Your Account

Step-by-step login process:

- Go to Login Page - Navigate to the BookNest login page
- Enter Username - Type your username (usually your membership ID or email)
- Enter Password - Type your password carefully (it is case-sensitive)
- Click Login - Click the blue Login button

2.2 Forgot Your Password?

If you cannot remember your password, follow these steps:

- Click on Forgot Password? link on the login page
- Enter your email address or membership ID
- Click Send Reset Link
- Check your email for the password reset link
- Click the link and create a new password

2.3 First Time Users

New members should follow these steps:

- Register at the library counter with your ID proof
- Get your username and temporary password from the librarian
- Login with these temporary credentials
- Change your password in My Account section

Security Tip

Keep your password secure and never share it with others. Change it regularly for better security.

3. Main Dashboard

3.1 Dashboard Overview

After logging in, you will see your personal dashboard with useful information about your borrowing activity. Key Dashboard Sections:

- Welcome Message - Personalized greeting with your name
- Quick Stats - Number of books borrowed, due dates, and penalties

- My Books - List of books currently borrowed
- Search Bar - Quick search for new books
- Navigation Menu - Access to all system features

3.2 Dashboard Navigation

The menu bar at the top contains:

Menu Item	What You Can Do
Home	Return to dashboard
Search Books	Find books by title, author, or keyword
My Books	View borrowed books and due dates
My Account	Update profile and password
Journals	Browse journal subscriptions
Help	Access FAQ and contact support
Logout	Exit the system securely

4. Searching for Books

4.1 Basic Search Methods

Find books in three easy ways:

Method 1: Title Search

15. Click Search Books in the main menu
16. Enter the complete or partial title
17. Press Enter or click the Search button

Method 2: Author Search

- Click Advanced Search option
- Select Author from the dropdown menu

- Type the author's name and click Search

Method 3: Category Browse

- Click Browse by Category
- Select the book category (Fiction, Science, History, etc.)
- Browse the list of available books

4.2 Understanding Search Results

Each search result shows the following information:

- Book Title - The name of the book
- Author - Who wrote the book
- Publisher - Publishing company
- Year - Year of publication
- Availability - Available or Not Available
- Call Number - Library location code

4.3 View Book Details

Click on any book to see full details including: complete book information and description, cover image (if available), available copies in different branches, edition and binding type, and ISBN number.

5. Borrowing Books

5.1 How to Borrow a Book

Follow these steps to borrow a book:

- Find the Book - Search for the book you want using the search feature
- Check Availability - Make sure it shows Available status
- Click Borrow - Click the green Borrow button on the book details page
- Confirm Request - Review your request and click Confirm
- Get Receipt - Note the receipt number shown on screen

Next Step

Visit the library counter with your receipt number to collect the book. The librarian will scan your ID and provide the physical book.

5.2 Borrowing Limits

Different member types have different borrowing limits:

Member Type	Max Books	Loan Period
Students	5 books	14 days
Faculty/Staff	10 books	30 days
Book Bank Members	15 books	60 days

5.3 What If a Book is Not Available?

If the book you want is currently borrowed, you can place a hold request:

- Click Request Hold on the book details page
- You will be notified when it is returned
- You will receive an email notification when ready for collection

6. Returning Books

6.1 How to Return a Book

Returning books is simple. Bring the Book to the library, visit the return desk/counter, submit your book to the librarian, and receive a return receipt with confirmation.

6.2 Checking Due Dates

You can see your due dates anytime by logging into your account, clicking My Books from the menu, viewing all borrowed books listed with their due dates, and noting that books are highlighted in RED if they are overdue.

6.3 Automatic Reminders

The system sends automatic reminders including email reminder 3 days before due date, dashboard notification showing days remaining, and red highlight if the book is overdue.

6.4 Late Returns and Penalties

If you return a book late, a penalty will be automatically calculated. Penalty equals the number of days late multiplied by the daily rate. You must pay the penalty at the library counter. Check My Account > Penalties to see the amount.

7. Renewing Books

7.1 What is Book Renewal?

Book renewal allows you to extend your borrowing period if no one else has requested the book. This gives you more time without having to return and reborrow it.

7.2 How to Renew a Book

- Click My Books from the main menu
- Locate the book you want to renew
- Click the blue Renew button next to the book
- Confirm the renewal action

7.3 Renewal Rules

- You can renew up to 3 times for the same book
- Each renewal extends the due date by one full period
- Cannot renew if someone else has placed a hold
- Cannot renew if you have outstanding penalties
- Renewal happens instantly through the system

8. Viewing Your Account

8.1 Accessing Your Account

To view your account information, click My Account in the top menu, view your personal information, update profile details if needed, and change your password for security.

8.2 Account Information Displayed

Information	Details
Name	Your full name
Member ID	Your unique library membership number

Member Type	Student, Staff, or Faculty
Email	Your registered email address
Phone	Your contact number
Department	Your academic or work department
Status	Active, Inactive, or Suspended

8.3 Viewing Your Borrowing History

To see your complete borrowing history, click My Account > Borrowing History, view all books you have ever borrowed with issue date, return date, and days kept, and filter by date range if needed.

9. Understanding Penalties

9.1 What are Penalties?

A penalty is a fine charged when you return a book after the due date. This encourages members to return books on time so others can use them.

9.2 How Penalties are Calculated

Penalty = Number of Days Late x Daily Penalty Rate. Each day after due date counts as one day. Different rates may apply for different book types. For example: 5 days late x Rs. 5/day = Rs. 25 penalty.

9.3 Impact of Unpaid Penalties

- Cannot borrow new books
- Cannot renew existing books
- Account may be suspended
- Reminder emails will be sent

Money Saving Tip

Return books on time to avoid penalties. Set phone reminders for your due dates!

10. Journal Management

10.1 What are Journals?

Journals are periodical publications (monthly, quarterly, etc.) that contain research articles and current information in specific fields. Libraries subscribe to journals to provide the latest research to members.

10.2 Accessing Journals

- Click Journals in the main menu
- Find journals by name, subject, or publisher
- Click on a journal to see more information

10.3 Journal Information

Each journal listing shows journal title and field of study, publication frequency, publisher name, subscription status (Active/Expired), available issues/volumes, and link to online access if available.

11. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I borrow books in bulk?

Yes, but you must respect your borrowing limit. You can place multiple requests and collect them over time.

Q: What happens if I lose a book?

Report lost books immediately to the library counter. You may be asked to pay the replacement cost.

Q: Can I borrow books across different library branches?

Yes, BookNest works across all branches. You can request a book from any branch and collect it from your preferred location.

Q: Is my library information secure?

Yes! Your personal information is protected with secure login and encrypted connections. Never share your password with anyone.

Q: How long does it take to process a book request?

Usually within 24 hours. You will receive an email notification when the book is ready for collection.

12. Getting Help

12.1 Common Issues and Solutions

Issue: Cannot Login

Check that Caps Lock is OFF. Verify you are entering correct username. Click Forgot Password? to reset. Contact librarian if still unable to login.

Issue: Book Not Showing in Search

Try searching by author instead of title. Check spelling of the title. The book may be out of catalog. Ask librarian to manually search.

Issue: Cannot Borrow Book

Check your borrowing limit. Verify you have no outstanding penalties. Confirm your membership is active.

12.2 Contacting Support

If you need help, visit the library counter, email support@library.edu, call the helpline during office hours, or use the Help Chat feature in the system.

12.3 Library Hours

Day	Hours
Monday - Friday	8:00 AM - 6:00 PM
Saturday	9:00 AM - 2:00 PM
Sunday	CLOSED

12.4 Tips for Success

- Keep your password secure
- Check your email for library notifications
- Return books on time to avoid penalties
- Set phone reminders for due dates
- Update your contact information

13. Quick Reference Guide

A summary of key actions and information for quick lookup:

Quick Access Links

Action	How to Access
Search Books	Main menu > Search Books
View My Books	Main menu > My Books
Update Profile	My Account > Edit Profile
View Penalties	My Account > Penalties
Borrow a Book	Book details page > Borrow button
Renew a Book	My Books > Renew button
Request a Book	Book details page > Request Hold

14. Glossary

Key terms and definitions used in BookNest:

Availability: The status indicating whether a book is currently available for borrowing.

Book Hold: A request to reserve a book that is currently borrowed.

Borrowing Limit: The maximum number of books a member can borrow at one time.

Call Number: A code assigned to each book indicating its library location.

ISBN: International Standard Book Number - a unique 13-digit book identifier.

Journal: A periodical publication containing research articles and current information.

Membership ID: Your unique library account number.

Overdue: A book that has not been returned by its due date.

Penalty: A fine charged for returning a book after the due date.

Renewal: Extending the borrowing period of a book.

Thank you for using BookNest!

We are here to help you discover the world of knowledge.

Happy Reading!